

Bad Medicine Blues

The Companion Workbook

Your space to turn the reading into your own healing.

How to use this workbook

This workbook walks beside the book. Fill it in slowly, in any order, in pen or pencil or not at all on the hard days. There are no wrong answers, only honest ones. Aim for most days rather than perfect ones. Keep it somewhere you will see it.

A note before you begin: this workbook is for education and self-reflection. It is not medical advice, it does not diagnose or treat anything, and it never replaces care from your own licensed providers. Never start, stop, or change a medication on your own. When in doubt, ask your doctor.

My Starting Point

Before you change anything, take an honest snapshot of today. You will be glad you did when you look back in a month. Rate each one as it is right now.

Energy 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Sleep quality 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Digestion 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Mood 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Pain 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Stress 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Why did I pick up this book, and what am I hoping for?

My three loudest symptoms right now:

1. _____
2. _____

3. _____

When did I last feel really good in my body, and what was going on in my life then?

My Health Timeline

This is the exercise from Chapter 2. List your symptoms and rough turning points in order, along with what else was happening in your life at the time. Patterns hide in the whole page.

Symptom or event / Roughly when / What else was going on

Laid out flat, what patterns or connections jump out at me?

Part I — The Wake-Up

What is my own version of the trail moment, the point I am ready to stop waiting?

What have I been waiting for someone else to fix, that I could start on myself this week?

Part II — Foundations

Food

Subtraction first. Three things I will take out, or cut back on, this week:

My simple real-food plate looks like:

The one swap I will make this week (oil, drink, or breakfast):

Three-day food-and-feeling log (what I ate, and how I felt a few hours later):

Light, Sleep, Movement, and the Ground

My sleep audit:

Usual bedtime _____ Usual wake time _____ Hours _____

Room as dark as I can make it

Screens off in the last stretch before bed

Morning light within an hour of waking

My morning-light plan:

Movement I can actually sustain right now:

Grounding this week (tick each day I get bare feet on the earth):

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

Minerals and Testing

Questions to bring to my practitioner about testing:

Part III — The Tools I Leaned On

For each area, notice whether you feel a pull toward it, one small thing you could try, and a question you would want to ask a professional. There is no need to try everything.

Functional medicine

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Naturopathic and autoimmune care

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Iodine and the thyroid

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Gut health

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Herbs, mushrooms, and foraging

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Homeopathy

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Touch and bodywork

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Frequencies and devices

Curious? Yes Not yet One small thing to try: _____

A question I would ask a professional: _____

Part IV — The Inner Work

Nervous-system practice log (tick each day I take two minutes of slow breathing):

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

What has my body been carrying that no diet can reach?

Who is already in my corner, and who could be?

Becoming my own advocate would look like:

The 30-Day Gentle Start

Work through the four weeks from the appendix. Tick what you do, and jot one honest line at the end of each week.

Week one: subtract and observe

Took out one processed food or sugary drink

Swapped my cooking oil

Ten minutes of morning light most days

Three lines in my notebook each night

One line on how week one went:

Week two: add the foundations

A real breakfast with protein and fat

A short walk most days

Darker evenings, screens off before bed

A few minutes barefoot when I could

One line on how week two went:

Week three: calm the system

Two minutes of slow breathing daily

One calming ritual that fit my life

Went gently when hard things surfaced

One line on how week three went:

Week four: reflect and choose my next thread

Read back through my notebook

Named the one loudest thread

Chose a single next step, with a practitioner if I could

One line on how week four went:

My SMART Goal

Turn a vague hope into something you can actually follow. Fill in the blanks.

By _____ (date), I will _____
(specific action), so that _____
(measurable result), because _____
(why it matters to me).

A second one, when you are ready:

My Wins Log

Small victories count the most, and they are easy to forget. Write one down whenever it happens, however tiny.

My Closing Snapshot

Come back to this page after a month of the foundations. Re-rate each one as it is now, and compare it to your Starting Point.

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What changed, even a little?

My one next step from here:

However far you have come, you showed up for yourself, and that is the whole beginning. Keep listening to your body. It has been talking to you all along.